

Zaher Karp, MPH

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Research Interests

Healthcare data engineering and analytics in regulated environments. Particular focus on CMS Medicare Stars and HEDIS quality measurement, forecasting under regulatory constraints, and the design of compliant, governed data platforms. Earlier work in health services research on primary care systems, EHR optimization, and accountable care.

Education

Undergraduate

2003–2007 Bachelor of Arts, English Literature. University of Wisconsin–Madison.

Graduate

2015 Master of Public Health, Biostatistics. University of Wisconsin–Madison. Committee: Nancy Pandhi (MD, MPH, PhD; family medicine and health services research), Sandra Kamnetz (MD; family medicine), Todd Molfenter (PhD; industrial and systems engineering).

2013–2015 Graduate Certificate, Patient Safety. University of Wisconsin–Madison. Advisor: Pascale Carayon (PhD; industrial and systems engineering).

Fellowships and Training

2016, 2017 Dissemination and Implementation Short Course. Institute for Clinical and Translational Research, University of Wisconsin School of Medicine and Public Health.

2016 Digital Fellow. Organizing for Action, Chicago, Illinois.

2015 Wisconsin Entrepreneurial Boot Camp Fellow. University of Wisconsin School of Business.

2014 Systems Engineering Initiative for Patient Safety Short Course. Center for Quality and Productivity Improvement, Madison, Wisconsin.

2014 Contemporary Qualitative Interviewing Methods. University of Oxford, United Kingdom.

2013–2015 Research Trainee. Health Innovation Program, University of Wisconsin School of Medicine and Public Health.

2013 Focus Group Moderator Training (Richard A. Krueger and Mary Anne Casey). Institute for Clinical and Translational Research, University of Wisconsin School of Medicine and Public Health.

2013 Research Staff Training Course in Qualitative Methods. Institute for Clinical and Translational Research, University of Wisconsin School of Medicine and Public Health.

Appointments

2025–present Baltimore Health Analytics, Manager, Data Science and Engineering. Owns the data platform for a Medicare Advantage analytics product, including the regulatory validation layer against CMS technical specifications, and leads a distributed engineering and QA team.

2017–2025 Healthfinch (acquired by Health Catalyst), Analytics Manager. Built and led the analytics data platform supporting value-based care across more than fifty health systems, including the infrastructure migration following the Health Catalyst acquisition.

Past Research Positions

2015–2018 Assistant Researcher. Department of Family Medicine and Community Health, University of Wisconsin School of Medicine and Public Health.

2013–2015 Project Assistant. Departments of Family Medicine and Pediatrics, University of Wisconsin School of Medicine and Public Health.

2013–2015 Project Assistant. Center for Patient Partnerships, University of Wisconsin School of Law.

2013 Associate Research Specialist. Department of Pediatrics, University of Wisconsin School of Medicine and Public Health.

2012–2013 Research Specialist. Department of Family Medicine, University of Wisconsin School of Medicine and Public Health.

2009–2012 Associate Research Specialist. Department of Family Medicine, University of Wisconsin School of Medicine and Public Health.

Publications

1. Karp Z, Kamnetz S, Wietfeldt N, Sinsky C, Molfetter T, Pandhi N. Influence of environmental design on team interactions across 3 family medicine clinics. *Health Environments Research & Design Journal*. 2019;12(4):159–173. PMID: 30913920. Cited 13 times.
2. Pandhi N, Gaines ME, Deci D, Schlesinger M, Culp C, Karp Z et al. Broadening medical students' exposure to the range of illness experiences: a pilot experimental curriculum trial. *Academic Medicine*. 2019. PMID: 31348072. Cited 4 times.
3. Berkson S, Davis S, Karp Z, Jaffery J, Flood G, Pandhi N. Medicare Shared Savings Programs: higher cost accountable care organizations are more likely to achieve savings. *International Journal of Healthcare Management*. 2018.
4. Pandhi N, Jacobson N, Serrano N, Hernandez A, Zeidler-Schreiter E, Wietfeldt N, Karp Z. An efficient process of gathering diverse community opinions to inform an intervention. *Implementation Science*. 2016;11(Suppl 1):A13.
5. Pandhi N, Yang WL, Karp Z, Young A, Beasley JW, Kraft S, Carayon P. Approaches and challenges to optimizing primary care teams' electronic health record usage. *Journal of Innovation in Health Informatics*. 2014;21(3):142–51. PMID: 25584902. Cited 24 times.
6. Yang W, Pandhi N, Karp Z, Young A, Beasley J, Kraft S, Carayon P. Approaches and challenges to optimizing the use of EHRs in primary care (preliminary findings). *Proceedings of World Conference on E-Learning, Montréal*. 2012.

Presentations

- 2017 Karp Z, Kamnetz S, Wietfeldt N, Pandhi N. Primary care patient perceptions of clinic design across three practices. Podium presentation, National Collaborative for Improving Primary Care Through Industrial and Systems Engineering (I-PrACTISE), Madison, WI.
- 2016 Pandhi N, Karp Z, Kamnetz S, Trowbridge E. Developing an effective writing collaborative to rapidly disseminate lessons from system redesign. Workshop, Association of American Medical Colleges Integrating Quality Meeting, Chicago, IL.
- 2016 Karp Z, Kamnetz S, Pandhi N. Primary care team perceptions of team-based care and clinic design types across three practices. Podium presentation, National Collaborative for Improving Primary Care Through Industrial and Systems Engineering (I-PrACTISE), Madison, WI.
- 2015 Karp Z. Participatory research and community engagement. Field Innovation Team Bootcamp, Provo, UT.

- 2015 Karp Z, Wietfeldt N, Pandhi N. Approaches to involving diverse community partners and patients in integrated mental health research. Seminar, Access, Quality, and Outcomes Research Network, Appleton, WI.
- 2015 Pandhi N, Jacobson N, Serrano N, Hernandez A, Zeidler-Schreiter E, DeCheck N, Karp Z. An efficient process of gathering diverse community opinions to inform an intervention. Society for Implementation Research Collaboration Conference, Seattle, WA.
- 2015 Karp Z. Influences of the primary care clinic environment on patients and staff: preliminary findings. Podium presentation, National Collaborative for Improving Primary Care Through Industrial and Systems Engineering (I-PrACTISE), Madison, WI.
- 2012 Yang W, Pandhi N, Karp Z, Young A, Beasley J, Kraft S, Carayon P. Approaches and challenges to optimizing the use of electronic health records in primary care. World Conference on E-Learning in Corporate, Government, Healthcare, and Higher Education, Montréal, QC.
- 2012 Pandhi N, Yang W, Karp Z. Clinical application specialists: meeting themes. Presentation to UW Health organizational leadership, Middleton, WI.

Posters

- 2017 Karp Z, Crowder M, Davis S, Jacobson N, Quanbeck A, Hass M, Pandhi N. Identifying effective strategies for scaling an intervention to engage patients in care redesign. UW Institute for Clinical and Translational Research Dissemination and Implementation Short Course, Madison, WI.
- 2015 Karp Z, Wietfeldt N, Pandhi N. Involving community partners in integrated mental health research. UW Health Quality Week, Madison, WI.
- 2015 Pandhi N, Jacobson N, Wietfeldt N, Karp Z, Zeidler-Schreiter E, Serrano N, Hernandez A. Engaging the community in identifying and prioritizing outcomes for integrated primary care behavioral health. North American Primary Care Research Group Conference, Cancún, Mexico.
- 2015 Karp Z, Wietfeldt N, Pandhi N. Involving community partners in integrated mental health research. Wisconsin Research and Education Network Convocation of Practices, Oshkosh, WI.
- 2014 Karp Z, Kamnetz S, Pandhi N. Influences of the primary care clinic environment on patients and staff: research design. National Collaborative for Improving Primary Care Through Industrial and Systems Engineering (I-PrACTISE), Madison, WI.

- 2014 Pandhi N, Berkson S, Caplan W, Davis S, Kamnetz S, Koslov S, Trowbridge E, Karp Z, Kraft S. Finding a PATH to support scholarly careers: Primary care Academics Transforming Healthcare. Association of American Medical Colleges Integrating Quality Meeting, Chicago, IL.
- 2014 Kwak A, Gibbs B, Smith J, Karp Z, Lauscher R, Gray K. Birth date identification for limited English proficiency patients. Pharmacy Society of Wisconsin Annual Meeting, Madison, WI.
- 2010 Young A, Pandhi N, Karp Z. Using the charting tool Smart Phrase to improve the quality of care provided to patients with chronic pain. Wisconsin Primary Care Research and Quality Improvement Forum, Middleton, WI.

Grants and Funding

- 2016–2017 Patient Engagement in Care Redesign: Identifying Effective Strategies for Measuring and Scaling the Intervention. UW Institute for Clinical and Translational Research, Dissemination and Implementation Research Award (PIs: Nancy Pandhi, Sarah Davis). Role: Researcher and Quality Coach.
- 2016–2017 Care Delivery Changes Associated with Care Model Redesign. Department of Family Medicine Small Grant Program (PI: Jennifer Lochner). Role: Statistician and Compliance Manager.
- 2016–2017 From Patient Voice to Patients' Voices: Using Patient Experience to Enhance Medical Education. Josiah Macy Jr. Foundation President's Grant (PI: Rachel Grob). Role: Statistician and Compliance Manager.
- 2014–2017 The Effectiveness of an Integrated Mental Health and Primary Care Model for Wisconsin Patients with Severe Mental Illness. Wisconsin Partnership Program, New Investigator Program Grant (PI: Nancy Pandhi). Role: Statistician and Compliance Manager.
- 2014–2015 Influences of the Primary Care Clinic Environment on Patients and Staff. Department of Family Medicine Small Grant Program (PI: Sandra Kamnetz). Role: Primary Researcher and Compliance Manager (master's thesis project).
- 2014–2015 Engaging Stakeholders and Developing Partners in Mental Health and Primary Care Integration Research. UW Institute for Clinical and Translational Research, Patient-Centered Outcomes Research Award (PI: Nancy Pandhi). Role: Lead Qualitative Research Analyst and Compliance Manager.
- 2009–2014 Continuity of Care and the Health of Older Adults. National Institute on Aging (PI: Nancy Pandhi). Role: Research Assistant.

Awards and Honors

2021 Spirit of Charlie Award. Health Catalyst.

2017 Alumni Hall Service Award. Department of Family Medicine and Community Health, University of Wisconsin School of Medicine and Public Health.

2015 Patient Choice Award (awarded to Pandhi et al.). North American Primary Care Research Group Meeting.

2009 International IPM Excellence Award. IPM Institute of North America.

Certifications

2024 Academy Accreditation, Databricks Fundamentals. Databricks.

2020 Search Mastery Certification. Sumo Logic.

2020 Fundamentals Certification. Sumo Logic.

2015 Certified Six Sigma Yellow Belt. American Society for Quality.

Service and Professional Activities

University Service

2014–2017 Undergraduate Research Scholar Mentor. University of Wisconsin School of Medicine and Public Health.

Community Service

2015–present Field Innovator. Field Innovation Team, Heber City, UT.

2016–2020 Board of Directors. The Road Home of Dane County, Madison, WI.

2013–2015 Community Advisory Board Chair. WORT 89.9 FM, Madison, WI. Elected to two terms.

2013–2014 State Newsletter Editor. Sierra Club, Madison, WI.

2013 Writer. Goodman Community Center, Madison, WI. Raised \$3,000 for early childhood facilities.

2008–2009 Editor. Sustain Dane, Madison, WI.

Peer Review

2019–present Institute of Industrial and Systems Engineers Transactions on Healthcare Systems Engineering.

2019–present Health Environments Research and Design Journal.

Mentoring

2016–2017 G. Padgett. Undergraduate Research Scholar Program; literature review, qualitative analysis, and mentored self-reflection.

2016–2017 Y. Dominguez. Undergraduate Research Scholar Program; data cleaning, programming, data visualization, literature review, and mentored self-reflection.

2014–2016 C. Minten. Undergraduate Research Scholar Program; data cleaning, programming, data visualization, statistical analysis, and poster presentation.